MONTHLY UPDATE

Standards: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *22 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

BENIN · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GAMBIA · GHANA · KENYA · LIBERIA · LIBYA · MALI · MAURITANIA · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · NAMIBIA · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SEYCHELLES · SOUTH SUDAN · SUDAN · TANZANIA · TOGO · TUNISIA · ZAMBIA

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Benin

The state digital agency presented a national cybersecurity reference framework for AI systems to the administration's information-systems directors on 8 October 2026: four risk tiers from minimal to unacceptable, an AI officer and an ethics committee, and traceability of system decisions.

Ethiopia

A standing readiness instrument the repository had not held was named from practice rather than from the regulator. A practitioner's case is that a central bank microfinance directive of 2022 already defines the governance, risk-management and operational readiness that institutions skip when they buy digital wallets before building the capability to run them. The directive text is not held and no supervisory finding, enforcement action or compliance count is published, so what the repository has is the rule's existence and one account of how it is being ignored.

Gabon

The regional internet registry presented its services to the technical community at a workshop in Libreville on 10 September 2026, held at the initiative of the national internet exchange point and focused on the transition to IPv6.

Gambia

The standards bureau's position was restated from both ends this month. Its director general put adoptions at around 500 standards, alongside membership of the African standards organisation, while the international body's own profile records the bureau as a Correspondent member without a vote at the standards and electrotechnical organisations, and the country's technical-barriers enquiry point. A correspondent member may adopt standards; it does not help make them.

Ghana

The central bank directed banks to give their fraud functions direct access to the chief executive, alongside work on implementing the directive.

On 8 October the central bank announced thematic reviews of how banks have implemented the revised cyber and information security directive.

The health service, with WHO support, convened a national workshop to review the Medical Records Strategy and Operational Guidelines, written nearly a decade ago, so that they cover electronic medical records, data governance, interoperability, cybersecurity and artificial intelligence. No revised text or adoption date is published.

Kenya

The technology authority put the National Information Security Framework's audit, risk-management and certification toolkits to a stakeholder workshop in Nairobi, reported on 7 September, to test whether they are practical before critical information infrastructure is certified. The central bank said its AI survey will feed a guidance note for the banking sector on data and AI governance, risk mitigation and third-party vendors; no draft or date is published.

Liberia

The education ministry opened a five-day session to develop and validate a Statutory School Record-Keeping Booklet, one nationwide system for school records on students, teachers, attendance and infrastructure. How the booklet relates to the education management information system being modernised is not stated.

Libya

The committee behind the national information system spent its sixth meeting fixing its own composition. Meeting in Tripoli on 1 September it reviewed financial indicators and settled its membership rules, tying permanent seats to the office of director of an information and documentation centre and requiring a written letter for a proxy. Its mandate, its published output and the indicators it reviewed are not held — what is established is that it meets, and now who sits on it.

Mali

The standards agency's fourteenth ordinary board session balanced a 2026 budget of CFA 243,306,303 against CFA 318,369,036 in 2025, a fall of about a quarter, and it holds a correspondent member profile with the international standards organisation. The agency was created by ordinance in March 2012; no standard adopted, certification issued or staffing figure is published.

Mauritania

The state asked for outside help with the numbers behind its own borrowing. The finance minister received an International Monetary Fund technical assistance mission on public finance statistics and state-owned enterprise debt, working on compilation in line with the 2014 government finance statistics manual and reviewing progress on the collection, reliability and consolidation of state-enterprise financial data. No baseline, target or publication commitment is stated for that data, so what is currently held about state-enterprise debt stays unknown.

Mauritius

Mauritius moved to bind its own digital services to a standard. Cabinet took note on 28 August of a Digital Service Framework setting mandatory principles and standards for every government digital service, from procurement through maintenance, and the government information service set out that the framework will cover every service developed, procured or maintained by the state. Noted is not issued: the record held carries no compliance date, no owner and no consequence for a service that fails it.

Mozambique

The regulator reported a 95.2% resolution rate for consumer complaints about communications services and attributed much of the rise in complaints to better recording: one operator's logged complaints went from 213 to 24,036 after it deployed incident tracking.

Namibia

How the state speaks was standardised before what it runs was. The communications minister launched a harmonised government communication strategy for 2026 to 2030 and a government corporate brand identity manual, both approved by cabinet in March 2026. No implementation plan, and no compliance requirement on ministries, is published.

Nigeria

The device register went live and met resistance. The board stated the Device Management System live, blocking stolen devices across networks, while manufacturers asked for a longer implementation timeline against a charge of about N670 per IMEI.

Rwanda

The standards bodies of Rwanda and Zambia signed a technical cooperation agreement at the continental standards general assembly in Mombasa, reported on 3 September, providing for mutual recognition of standards and conformity assessment results.

Seychelles

The department that would write government-wide standards restated its mandate rather than exercising it. Its own Policy, Standards and Research Section claims adopted technical standards for the seamless interoperability of e-government services, and the integration of every e-government application and database through established software and database standards. None of those standards is published, so the claim can be dated and not checked.

South Sudan

Standards work this month was participation in a regional process. The national communication authority took part in the third African preparatory meeting for the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference, hosted by Tunisia's frequency agency and coordinated by the African Telecommunications Union, where non-geostationary orbit and direct-to-device systems were among the items. No national position or delegation mandate is published.

Sudan

The White Nile branch of the standards body launched electronic collection of standards and metrology fees, reported on 15 September, issuing an electronic receipt at payment. No count of branches live is published.

Tanzania

Zanzibar's government told its House of Representatives on 9 September that a guideline on shared fibre poles and a single fibre contractor is being prepared, after each provider erected its own.

Togo

Under the food-system resilience programme the national standards agency drew up 46 national standards and the accreditation committee 31 certification programmes in August — drawn up and disseminated, the ministry says, not homologated. The telecoms regulator is drafting rules requiring at least 95 per cent nationwide compliance with quality-of-service standards, with penalties; no draft or date is published.

Tunisia

Tunisia's national frequency agency opened four days of talks in Tunis for the third African preparatory meeting for the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference, coordinated by the African Telecommunications Union, with governments and regulators working towards common positions on the frequencies used by mobile, satellite and other wireless services. No delegate count, agenda document or adopted position is published.

The cybersecurity agency's list of 17 September carries six N-Cloud entries, the label required of providers hosting public bodies' services to citizens and firms, on a business outlet's reading of the list.

Zambia

The trust layer under the interoperability standards was stood up. The communications regulator operationalised the National Digital Trust Anchor in its capacity as national root certification authority, the framework issuing and verifying digital certificates and signatures establishing the identity of people and organisations, on the legal base of the electronic communications and transactions statute. No certificate count, subordinate-authority list, accreditation route or fee schedule is published, and the launch reaches the repository through a news report rather than the regulator's own notice — which for a root certification authority is the one thing a relying party would want to be able to check. The national public key infrastructure was launched with a named security vendor, its master cryptographic keys generated under independently audited conditions, held offline and split among multiple custodians so that no single entity has unilateral control.

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